Jessica Yi Fei Bo

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto, Toronto, Canada
PhD in Computer Science, expected 2028
Topic: Human-AI interaction risks, e.g. over-reliance.
Advisor: Ashton Anderson *(Computational Social Science Lab)*

ETH Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland
MSc in Mechanical Engineering (Robotics), 2023
Thesis at **Massachusetts Institute of Technology** and **Harvard Medical School**.
Advisors: Giovanni Traverso, Hen-Wei Huang *(Laboratory for Translational Engineering)*

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC, Canada
BASc In Mechanical Engineering (Biomedical), 2020

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

Microsoft Research, New York City, NY, USA
Research Intern for FATE (Fairness, Accountability, Transparency, and Ethics in AI) | Summer 2026

Google, Mountain View, CA, USA
Student Researcher for Google AR | Fall 2024 – Winter 2025

National University of Singapore, Singapore
Research Assistant in the Ubicomp Lab | Winter – Summer 2023

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA, USA
Visiting Thesis Student in the Laboratory for Translational Engineering | 2022

École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL), Lausanne, Switzerland
Summer@EPFL Research Assistant in the Visual Intelligence and Learning Lab | Summer 2021

Attentiv Medical, Vancouver, BC, Canada
Co-Founder and Research Lead | 2020–2022

***Awards**: James Dyson National Winner (Canada) and International Top 20, Microsoft Discover AI - Healthcare Winner, Medical Device Design Center Principal Award, UBC Innovation on Board Start-Up Competition (Runner Up).*

Lund University, Lund, Sweden
Research Assistant in the CERTEC Rehabilitation Engineering Group | Sumer 2017

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Zhang TJ, Yasunaga OS, Jiang W, **Bo J**, Draye F, Javadov A, Singh A, Muir L, Oldemburgo De Mello V, Schölkopf B, Jin Z (2026). "SuperSycophantic: Stress-Testing Frontier LLMs from Single- to Multi-Turn Sycophancy". *NeurIPS 2026.*

Bo J, Xu T, Chatterjee I, Passarella-Ward K, Kulshrestha A*, Shin D* (2026). "Steerable Chatbots: Personalizing LLMs with Preference-Based Activation Steering". *UIST 2026.*

Grief-Albert S, **Bo J,** Jiao D, Anderson A (2026). "Emulate or Estimate? The Divergent Strengths of Base and Post-Trained Language Models for Opinion Simulation". *EMNLP 2026 Findings.*

Bo J, Aoyagui PA, Rismani S, Das D, Ahmed SI, Anderson A (2026). "Studying People to Study AI: Expert Perspectives on the Epistemic Fit and Barriers of Human Research in AI Safety & Ethics". *AIES 2026.*

Lee PYK*, **Bo J***, Zhao Z*, Aoyagui PA*, Varona M*, Anderson A, Kuzminykh A, Chevalier F, Nobre C (2026). "Large Language Lovers: Lived Experiences of Negotiating Agency and Platform Control in AI Companionship". *FAccT 2026.*

Bo J, Kazemitabaar M, Deng M, Inzlicht M, Anderson A (2025). "Invisible Saboteurs: Sycophantic LLMs Mislead Novices in Problem-Solving Tasks". Best Paper Honorable Mention at *CHI 2026.*

Bo J*, Mok L*, Anderson A (2026). "Language Models Exhibit Inconsistent Biases Towards Algorithmic Agents and Human Experts". *IASEAI 2026*.

Bo J, Wan S, Anderson A (2025). "To Rely or Not to Rely? Evaluating Interventions for Appropriate Reliance on Large Language Models". Best Paper Honorable Mention at *CHI 2025.*

Bo J*, Kumar H*, Liut M, Anderson A (2024). "Disclosures & Disclaimers: Investigating the Impact of Transparency Disclosures and Reliability Disclaimers on Learner-LLM Interactions". *HCOMP 2024.*

Bo J, Hao P, Lim B (2024). "Incremental XAI: Memorable Understanding of AI with Incremental Explanations". *CHI 2024*.

Bo J, Ta K, Nishida R, Yeh G, Tsang V, Bolton M, Ranger M, Walus K (2022). "ATTENTIV: Instrumented Peripheral Catheter for the Detection of Catheter Dislodgement in IV Infiltration". *IEEE EMBC 2022*.

Agrawal D*, Lobsiger J*, **Bo J,** Kaufmann V, Armeni I (2022). "HoloLabel: Augmented Reality User-In-The-Loop Online Annotation Tool for As-Is Building Information". *EC3 2022*.

JOURNALS PAPERS

Huang HW*, Chai P*, Kerssemakers T, Imani A, Chen J, Lee S, Heim M, **Bo J**, Wentworth A, Fabian N, Jenkins J, Pettinary A, Ishida K, Li J, You S, Hayward AM, Traverso G (2024). "An Implantable System for Opioid Safety (iSOS)". *Device*.

Vinker Y, Pajouheshgar E, **Bo J**, Bachmann R, Bermano AH, Cohen-Or D, Zamir A, Shamir A (2022). "CLIPasso: Semantically Aware Object Sketching". Best Paper at *SIGGRAPH 2022*.

PREPRINTS

Bo J, Ruo S, Glowacki H, Su E, Wong O, Anderson A (2026). "Better Plans, Worse Relations: How AI Scaffolding Mediates Human-Human Collaborative Communication in Planning Tasks". *In submission.*

Frascaria G, Hiterer D, Knearem T, Liang JT, Mao K, Shi Y, Simons D, Sinha AK, Zhu H, Andolina S, **Bo J**, …, Shen H (2026). "BiAlign Pyramid: A Design Space of Human–AI Alignment Mechanisms Across Scales". *In submission.*

Ye M, Ibrahim L, **Bo J**, Cheng M, Mattson I, Vennemeyer D, Kraut R, Rathje S (2026). "What Counts as AI Sycophancy? A Taxonomy and Expert Survey of a Fragmented Construct". *In submission.*

NON-ARCHIVAL ABSTRACTS

Bo J, Kazemitabaar M, Zhuang E, Anderson A. "Who's the Leader? Analyzing Novice Workflows in LLM-Assisted Debugging of Machine Learning Code". Paper at *CHI 2025 Tools-for-Thought Workshop.*

Zhao Z*, **Bo J***, Singh K (2024). "Make it Happier! Discretizing and Amplifying Happiness in Animated Faces". Poster at *Graphics Interfaces 2024*.

Bo J*, Mok L*, Tie J, Anderson A (2024). "Does GPT Distrust Algorithms? Evaluating Large Language Models for Algorithm Aversion". Paper at *CHI 2024 HEAL Workshop* and *IC2S2 2024*.

Bo J, Huang HW, Chan A, Traverso G (2022). "Adversarial Masking for Pretraining ECG Data Improves Downstream Model Generalizability". Paper at *ML4H 2022* and *TS4H* at *NeurIPS 2022* (co-located).

Bo J, Van der Loos M (2020). "Detection of Wheelchairs Using Laser Scanning Sensors for Mobile Robotics". Best Oral Presentation at *UBC MURC 2020*.

SELECT AWARDS

Vanier Canada Graduate Scholarship (*3 x 50,000 CAD*), NSERC Canada, 2025
Canada Graduate Scholarship – Doctoral (*declined due to Vanier*), NSERC Canada, 2025
Walter C. Sumner Memorial Fellowship (*15,7000 CAD*), Walter C. Sumner Foundation, 2024, 2025
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (*3 x 5,000 CAD*), Government of Ontario, 2024
Schwartz Reisman Graduate Fellow *(7500 CAD),* Schwartz Reisman Institute, 2024.
Wolfond Scholarship in Wireless Information Technology *(5000 CAD),* University of Toronto, 2024
Finalist for **Gates Cambridge Scholarship**, Cambridge University, 2023
Graduate Research Grant *(3400 USD)*, IEEE Computational Intelligence Society, 2022

Master Thesis Grant *(10,500 CHF)*, Zeno Karl Schindler Foundation, 2022
Swiss-European Mobility Scholarship *(4500 CHF)*, Swiss-European Mobility Programme, 2022
Heyning-Roelli Mobility Grant *(1100 CHF),* Heyning-Roelli Foundation, 2021
Women in Technology Scholarship *(10,000 CAD)*, Irving K Barber BC Scholarship Society, 2019

INVITED TALKS

Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society, "The Human Variable: Psychology for the AI Age" Conference, October 2026.

University of Alberta, Human-Centered AI Talk Series, June 2026.

Microsoft, AI Safety & Security Science Speaker Series, June 2026.

Massey College, Junior Fellows Lecture Series, February 2026.

ACADEMIC INVOLVEMENT

Teaching
CSC2702: Technical Entrepreneurship – TA for *Fall 2025, Fall 2026*
MIE242: Foundations of Cognitive Psychology – Guest Lecturer for *Fall 2026*
CSC311: Introduction to Machine Learning – TA for *Winter 2024*
CSC148: Introduction to Computer Science – TA for *Fall 2023*

Workshop Organizer
Graphic Interfaces 2025 – "The Role of AI-Empowered Machine Subjectivity in HCI Tasks"

Reviewer
Journals: Nature Communications Psychology
Conferences: CHI 2027, UIST 2026, COLM 2026, CUI 2026, CHI 2026, CSCW 2026, CHI 2025
Abstracts: CHI BiAlign 2026, CHI EA 2025, IC2S2 2025

Student Volunteer
UIST 2024, CHI 2024, NeurIPS 2022

VOLUNTEERING & OUTREACH

Massey College, University of Toronto
Junior Fellow | 2025–ongoing

Computer Science Graduate Society (CSGS), University of Toronto
Graduate Affairs Committee Representative | 2023–ongoing

Graduate Application Assistance Program (GAAP), University of Toronto
Lead Organizer | 2025
Mentor for Prospective Applicants | 2023, 2024, 2025

Women in Science and Engineering, University of Toronto
Mentor for Undergraduate Students | 2024

Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto
Graduate Admissions Triager | Fall 2023

Traverso Lab Machine Learning Corner, Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Reading Group Organizer | 2022

Open Roboethics Institute, Montreal, QC, Canada (remote)
AI Fairness Toolkit & Roboethics Competitions | 2021–2023

UBC Biomedical Engineering Student Team, University of British Columbia
Research Team for Orthopedic Medical Device | 2016–2020